

“Respect for Authority” Academy
(Middle/High School)

Safety Concerns Lesson Plan

Please obtain administrator approval prior to implementing this lesson.

Objectives:

- Students will examine the most common risk factors associated with their age group.
- Students will review how rules and laws established by those in authority help keep them safe.
- Students will have an opportunity to show appreciation for those in authority who help keep them safe.

Protective Factor Developed: Connection/Commitment to school

Materials:

- ✓ Large poster paper and markers for each group
- ✓ Higher/Lower Signs
- ✓ Authority Figure Cards see slides, 1 per group
- ✓ Risky Situation Card, see slides
- ✓ Facilitator Guide pg. 4

Timeframe: 50 minutes

Team Teaching: For effective implementation of Law Related Education (LRE), team teach with the classroom teacher by...

- Having both the officer and teacher rotate among students and to different groups. Both instructors will provide positive feedback and engage in friendly conversations with students. This procedure will help reduce classroom disruptions, increase student engagement, and build supportive relationships with students.
- Encouraging classroom teachers to participate in all activities by injecting clarification statements by relating relevant content to their curriculum. In this method, students will see more connections to their student life and be willing to carry over concepts and skills learned in LRE.
- Assigning the classroom teacher part of the lesson instructions. Team teaching with the classroom teacher enables the students to further see the importance of LRE lessons. It also provides an opportunity for the classroom teacher to demonstrate teaching skills conducive for effective teaching. Student attention can be maintained more easily with different voices and personalities experienced throughout the lesson.

Lesson:

1. Divide students into small groups of 3 or 4 students each. Provide each group with **large poster paper and markers**.
2. Instruct students to visualize a sports player preparing for a game. Have each group pick a different sport (football, baseball, NASCAR) and have them discuss the risks associated with that sport. Have a group volunteer report out.
2. Next, have groups draw a picture of an athlete without any protective equipment. Now have groups discuss and brainstorm the different lengths an athlete goes through to prepare for a game. Instruct groups to add pieces of protective equipment to their athlete and record why each piece is important.
3. Have groups post their pictures on the walls and report about the risks, preparation, and protection needed for their sport.
4. After groups take their seats have them brainstorm safety concerns or risk factors for students at their age; be ready to report out.

Possible Responses: make sure the administrator supports teaching these topics before expanding on them

- Vehicle Accidents
 - DUI/ Driving with Persons Under the Influence
 - Violence/Bullying
 - Drug Use
 - Suicide
 - Teen Pregnancy
 - Cyber Bullying
 - Runaway
 - Date Rape / Sexual Exploitation
5. Next, inform the class that they will be asked a series of questions regarding some risk factors/safety concerns they have mentioned. These questions will include facts about the specific risks and it will be their job to determine if the statistic is higher or lower than the number given. Post the following **signs: HIGHER -LOWER** at the opposite end of the room. One will say 'Higher' the other 'Lower'. When a question is asked, they will stand under the sign they believe is correct. Is the true statistic 'Higher' or 'Lower' than the one provided?
 6. Read the statistics from the **Facilitator Guide (pg. 4)**. Give the students an opportunity to stand under the sign they believe represents the true answer. After a few students have explained why they chose their answer, provide the correct answer, and discuss their feelings on the statistics. Whether it was a higher or lower statistic than what was expected. After all questions have been asked, instruct students to return to their groups at their desks.
 7. Next, remind students that people in positions of authority have the responsibility to protect youth in the discussed risky situations. Assign each group an authority figure or let groups pick from the **Authority Figure Cards (See Slides)**. They should also pick a **Risky Situation Card (See slides)**. Have them draw a picture of that authority figure equipped with tools to protect minors and help reduce the risk on their card. Be ready to share and explain your drawing.
 8. Next, instruct the groups to develop a celebration or way of showing appreciation to their authority figure that students could get involved with.
 9. Call on each group to present their idea to the class. (Optional: Work with a teacher to choose a student idea that could be possible and help students organize the appreciation celebration.)
 10. Debrief the lesson by instructing the groups to take turns sharing with their group an authority figure they respect and how they help youth reduce their risks and keep them safe.
 11. Call on volunteers to share their person with the class and tell why they chose them.



The Law-Related Education Academy is sponsored by the Arizona Foundation for Legal Services & Education with funding made possible by the Arizona Department of Education School Safety Program.

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Higher/Lower Facilitator Guide
Source: 2022 Arizona Youth Survey

https://www.azcjc.gov/Portals/0/Documents/pubs/AYSReports/2022/AYS_2022%20State_Report_FINAL_09072022.pdf

1. 20% of 8th, 10th and 12th graders reported using e-cigarettes. (Lower 18.9% decreased from 2020-2022)
2. 20% of 8th, 10th and 12th graders reported having seen or heard advertisements warning of the dangers of fentanyl. (Higher-26%; 70% reported they think people who use fentanyl are at great risk)
3. 20% of 8th, 10th and 12th graders reported currently belonging to a gang. (Lower-fewer than 1%)
4. 20% of 8th, 10th and 12th graders reported slight or no perceived risk of drug use. (Higher: 65%; Teens have a higher risk of addiction because their brain is still developing)
5. 20% of 8th, 10th and 12th graders reported having harassed or made fun of another person online or through text. (Lower-just under 20%)
6. 20% of 8th, 10th and 12th graders reported driving a vehicle while texting. (Higher-47%)



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Arizona State Standards Correlations

Civics and Government

7-12 S3C4 PO4b-c Explain the obligations and responsibilities of citizenship: obeying the law and voting.
8.C2.2 Explain specific roles, rights, and responsibilities of people in a society.
HS.C2.4 Analyze the responsibility of citizens.

Speaking and Listening:

SL.1 Prepare for and participate effectively in a range of conversations and collaborations with diverse partners, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly and persuasively.
SL.2 Integrate and evaluate information presented in diverse media and formats, including visually, quantitatively, and orally.

Visual Art

S1C4PO 201 Explain purposeful use of subject matter, symbols, and/or themes in his or her own artwork.
S1C4PO 302 Create artwork that communicate substantive meanings or achieve intended purposes